
CACR Depot Access Road — Concerns Regarding Option 7 Selection

Lisa Lynch <lisa.lynch3@gmail.com>

Sun, Jun 7, 2026 at 7:03 PM

To: Eamonn.Murtagh@transport.gov.ie

Cc: info@transport.gov.ie

Bcc: Adrian o'sullivan <adrian.browndog@gmail.com>

Dear Mr Murtagh,

I am writing to you as a directly affected resident and member of the local community near Ballyrichard, Carrigtwohill, Co. Cork, regarding Irish Rail's selection of Option 7 as the preferred depot access road for the Cork Area Commuter Rail (CACR) maintenance facility. This proposal was developed by Roughan & O'Donovan Consulting Engineers on behalf of Irish Rail and has been met with overwhelming public opposition from East Cork.

Irish Rail's own Option Selection Report acknowledges that Option 7's margin of preference over alternatives was narrow. Yet it is the only route that permanently acquires residential garden curtilage, and it scores Highly Negative — the worst possible rating, a score of 1 — on Noise and Vibration, with nine residential receptors within 100 metres, some within 30 metres. Independent ecological survey work has also confirmed the presence of five Annex IV bat species, two BoCCI Red-listed bird species, and hydrological connectivity to the Great Island Channel SAC along the Option 7 corridor — none of which has been formally assessed in the context of this route selection.

I wish to draw particular attention to Option 4 as a superior alternative from a public infrastructure perspective. The N25 Carrigtwohill to Midleton Upgrade Scheme has not been allocated funding (Cork RDTE, corkrdo.ie), and no timeline for its delivery has been confirmed. The corridor already experiences significant congestion, and in the event of an eastbound incident on the N25, there is currently no viable alternative route for traffic. Option 4's alignment would provide exactly this: a new access corridor through which local traffic could divert, delivering a meaningful public benefit beyond the depot's operational needs. Option 7, by contrast, serves only Irish Rail staff and operational traffic. As a use of public infrastructure funding, Option 4 represents considerably better value — its benefits extend to the wider community, not solely to the railway undertaking.

I respectfully ask that the Department seek an independent review of the option selection process, and that the concerns of affected residents be raised formally with Irish Rail's board ahead of any final determination. The consultation period closes on 19 June 2026, and we believe there is still time to reconsider.

Full technical grounds, source document references, and further detail are available at no2option7.org. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss this further.

Yours sincerely,
Lisa Lynch,

Ballyrichard,

Midleton,

Co Cork